

TEJAS SHARMA

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SUMMARY

Early-stage venture capital analyst with experience evaluating and supporting investments in technology-driven startups. Background spanning venture capital, startup founding, and accelerator ecosystems, with hands-on experience in due diligence, investment memo development, and founder evaluation.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Finance (MSF)

University of Arizona, Eller College of Management, Tucson, AZ

GPA: 3.92/4.000 | Academic Honors: Eller Academic Excellence Awardee, 3x Dean's List Awardee

12/2025

Bachelor of Management Studies, Specialization in Finance

Shiv Nadar University, School of Management & Entrepreneurship, Delhi-NCR, India

05/2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Venture Capital Analyst (Wildcat Philanthropic Seed Fund)

Tech Launch Arizona | Tucson, United States | 05/2025 – Present

- Conducted deep-dive due diligence supporting WPSF's first three convertible-note investments in CarbeniumTec (energy storage), LifeSpan Digital Health (digital health), and UGenome AI (genomics), evaluating IP defensibility, commercialization pathways, and market opportunity, and presenting investment memos to the fund's Investment Committee.
- Built financial models and conducted market analyses to support diligence on early-stage MedTech, HealthTech, BioTech, and DeepTech ventures for the \$5M Wildcat Philanthropic Seed Fund, an evergreen venture fund affiliated with the University of Arizona.
- Authored investment memos and diligence reports for internal review by domain experts and stakeholders, synthesizing technology, market, and financial analyses to inform investment decisions.
- Participated in founder diligence meetings, evaluating IP-backed technologies, assessing commercialization feasibility, and benchmarking competitive landscapes using PitchBook and industry research.
- Contributed to capital strategy initiatives aimed at expanding WPSF's investor base by engaging with HNIs, alumni investors, and philanthropic networks supporting the fund.
- Developed startup evaluation frameworks and scoring rubrics, improving internal pipeline tracking and investment committee preparation.

Co-Founder & Finance Lead

FanFliQ | New Delhi, India | 11/2022 – 08/2024

- Co-founded FanFliQ, a music-tech SaaS platform serving independent creators, onboarding 1,000+ creators and improving revenue per creator by 20% through data-driven service bundling.
- Built financial models, pricing frameworks, and growth projections supporting a \$60K seed raise at a \$300K post-money valuation, presenting investor materials and negotiating early-stage financing terms.
- Led GTM analytics and user cohort analysis, reducing CAC by ~25% through channel prioritization and data-driven acquisition strategy.
- Analyzed retention and churn patterns to guide product iteration and creator engagement strategy during early-stage growth.

Entrepreneur in Residence (VC Analyst)

India Accelerator | Delhi-NCR, India | 03/2022 – 10/2022

- Advised 10+ early-stage startups across HealthTech and SME sectors on financial modeling, GTM strategy, and investor readiness, supporting fundraising from pre-seed to pre-Series A.
- Conducted startup screening and investment diligence using PitchBook and internal benchmarks to evaluate ventures aligned with the accelerator's investment thesis.
- Prepared founders for Demo Day fundraising, refining investor pitches, stress-testing business models, and developing investor-ready financial projections.
- Built portfolio tracking dashboards and KPI frameworks enabling accelerator leadership to monitor startup performance and investor reporting.

KEY ACADEMIC PROJECTS

University of Arizona Endowment Fund Investment Project (\$1M AUM)

FIN526 – Portfolio Management Theory, Eller College of Management, University of Arizona | 01/2025 – 05/2025

- Managed a \$1M endowment portfolio, with asset allocation of 70% to equities and 30% to fixed income using modern portfolio theory and factor-models (Fama-French) to create an optimal risk-return portfolio, targeting an annual alpha of 2-3%.
- Actively conducted in-depth financial analysis on 20+ equities and fixed-income securities, utilizing analysis of Fama-French 10-factor model's factor exposures to construct an alpha-generating portfolio, while presenting investment recommendations with 10+ key financial metrics (Sharpe ratio, beta, yield, drawdown) to faculty investment advisors for approval and implementation.

KEY SKILLS

Startup Due Diligence, Market Sizing, Financial Modeling, Investment Memo Writing, Startup Fundraising, Portfolio Analysis, GTM Analysis, Competitive Benchmarking, Advanced Excel, Python, VBA, PitchBook, Bloomberg Terminal, Stakeholder Communication